

Quarterly Dashboard: Are We on Track?

Seven readings to check before deciding the story has changed

Three or more reds for two quarters running: switch from gradual reform to emergency intervention



On Track



Watch



Intervene

1 Entry-Level Job Postings, YoY

Year-on-year change in junior openings

> -5%

-5% ~ -15%

< -15%

First visible sign of AI substitution: how fast junior roles vanish

2 E/P Ratio, 6-Month Change

Share of working-age adults actually employed

> -0.2pp

-0.2 ~ -0.5pp

< -0.5pp

Can't be flattered by people leaving the labour force — the jobless rate can

2b Long-Term Unemployed (27+ weeks)

As a share of all unemployed people

< 22%

22-26%

> 26%

Whether people get back out says more about a hiring freeze than how many are in

3 AI Capex as % of Revenue

How much of the top line goes into AI buildout

No crowd-out

Crowds out R&D

Crowds out staff

Separates healthy AI investment from using AI as layoff arbitrage

4 Frontier Accelerator Lead Times

Wait time for delivery of top-end AI chips

Falling ▼

Flat ►

Rising ▲

Whether compute supply keeps up with demand = how fast AI spreads

5 Pension Solvency, Years Payable

How long the fund can keep paying out

> 8 yrs

5-8 yrs

< 5 yrs

How urgent the tax shift from wages to capital/compute/carbon is

6 Housing Vacancy + Regional Bank Capital

Two mortgage-stress gauges read together

Both stable

One worsening

Both worsening

Early warning signal for a mortgage crisis

Why metric 2 isn't the unemployment rate

In a low-hiring, low-firing market the rate falls because people leave the labour force — the opposite signal.

Jan to Jul 2026 (BLS actuals):

Unemp. 4.3% ► 4.1% (looks better)

E/P ratio 59.4% ► 58.9% (actually worse)

Don't wait for the crisis to act, and don't panic while the data is still green. Check quarterly, act on signals.